Preface

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This collection was written between 2024 and the spring of 2025 — a period of introspection, narrative reconfiguration, and emotional intensity. It coincided with my final year in New York, and possibly my last chapter in America. During this time, I lived alone, gradually withdrawing from interpersonal entanglements. Communication became minimal, yet a growing spiritual dependence surged beneath the surface.

Born in Jiangsu, China, raised in Shanghai, and now writing from New York, I have lived across multiple cities and regions. These displacements have diluted my sense of "home," turning it into an abstract constellation rather than a fixed location. I've left traces everywhere, but nowhere I fully belong.

The subject who speaks here is fractured, suspended between fantasy, structure, and the Real. My understanding of these worlds borrows loosely from Lacanian thought: the subject split between what can be imagined, and what can be represented, and what is controlled by social rules. The worlds here are not just symbolic systems — they are personal mythologies. The self I write from is often just a mirror surface, responding to an unknowable other, or circling an unattainable center. There is no unified narrative, only fragments that momentarily align, like glimpses in a foggy window before the forest vanishes. I have organized the work into three porous dimensions:

Still Life unfolds as the internal world, my world—the site of subjective overflow and sensual reflection. It is the world as I see and feel it, colored by intuition, affect, and sometimes hallucination. My world is narrated by a mirror image of my being, telling stories about self and other worlds.

Bless You turns toward the others, your world. Here, "you" is not a singular person, but a condensation of attachment: a lover, a parent, a god, a ghost. The poems in this section collapse the boundaries between confession, belief, and intimacy, questioning what it means to address anyone at all. Your world floats with spiritual symbols and emotional connections, but there is no noise or voice. The world is waiting for an impulsive narrator.

Their World enters the symbolic—the mechanical world that defines and disfigures us. It is the terrain of institutions, roles, orders and ambient control, where we are both observed and made into observers. In these poems, the subject becomes plural: me, you, they. The line between watcher and watched dissolves.

These three worlds overlap constantly. We shift among them as we move through life, as we write, remember, and forget. The child who sees ghosts in a bedroom mirror becomes the adult who watches strangers through glass. The outcast becomes the enforcer of norms. The faithful become unmoored. In constructing these worlds, I have also imagined a utopia. In that space, we may finally refuse the roles assigned to us. We may become them, in the mechanical rules, or lose all symbolism altogether and become a singular child.

Writing, for me, becomes a way of circling the unreachable present — a moment that is always just ahead or already lost. I do not write to preserve time, but to approach what slips through it. The poems do not capture reality; they return to it again and again, from different angles, hoping to touch a vanishing future. In the past, I could hear your voice.

You invite me to pass through them. Not aim to find meaning or any answer, but to lose themselves in the memory.

Spring 2025

Their World

Breakfast

Breakfast, hello, America, I am in Boston.
Sunlight filters through the semi —
Transparent curtains into the room,
Behind transparent glass walls.
Green plants fill the bookshelves, non-renewable,
Seagulls perch on the terrace, watching, waiting.
On the plate, yellow eggs, green avocados,
Orange salmon, pink and white.
Wine glass on the dining bar has been replaced,
By a coffee machine, dense life, woody fragrance,
Charcoal grilling, clinging to the cup wall, remains,
Leaving traces of life from the classical era.

Sounds only leave room numbers, names unknown.
Shadows on the floor, moving,
Listening to murmuring sounds, on wooden tables,
Glass cups and forks clink, simple, ding-ding……
Indistinguishable, discovering conversation,
finding light and tea leaves sinking in cups,
Naturally, letting life continue, in the shadows.

I see someone, cutting salmon with a knife and fork,
Myself, from the reflection of metals,
Look at the faces on the wall, indigenous,
Smiling even when not being watched, endless.
Straight, pausing the typing motion,
Watching the blue sky, planes taking off and landing,
For about half an hour.
Until the body stops putting more life into the plate,
greedy and relentless.
Green plants, hide in books, freedom, food,
Hello, America, my breakfast.

Cottage

I watch my grandfather, sitting in his rocking chair,
In the hunter's cottage, the fire dances, cooking hot tea,
He fumbles with the wooden ball in his hand,
Turning it round and round. I sit on the mat.
My parents are not here.
Only motionless picture books, on this lonely night.

The leaves rustle outside, a cat meows from the tree,
Grandfather says he hears footsteps, many people.
Watching him fumble with the wooden ball,
His white hair dripping with sweat,
His eyes seem to grow, bulging out,
His mouth mumbling,
"They, they are coming."

I tell grandfather it's time to sleep.
He strokes my head. Tell me,
Someone will come, someone will leave,
Warm palms, please let me stay with you.

Then, slowly approaching, I fell asleep.
They have come.
Grandfather is gone. The cottage remains.

Shadow

All night, I lie in bed,
Staring at the shadows on the snow-white wall.

The round fan on the black suitcase,
where darkness blooms, plays.
The light casts the shadow of a black head.
Turning. Always turning.
Looking toward my sleeping feet, gradually approaching,
Yet never arriving.
Let us believe this is real, for now.
Though truth eludes us in just a breath.

In my childhood,
I often saw these shadows.
They stood around my bed, side by side.
Their faces, unclear, hidden from sight.
They spoke to me, nothing I can hear,
Only whispering and beckoning,
Asking me to join, to leave...

I remember my mother mentioning how —
I was often sick, feverish and trembling,
On those uneasy nights, when silence speaks volumes,
She too could see those shadows swaying outside the window,
Those shadows that watched me.
They licked the dust in the crevices,
Clearly amidst the sounds of falling leaves —
and withering flowers, a chorus of decay.

The small stream in front of our door flowed,
The sound of water concealing their footsteps,
Muffling their approach.
I lay in bed, feeling partially hot and cold,
Trapped between worlds, pains and plains.
I couldn't move, watching those shadows,
Those shadows that grew taller, surrounded.

They stood by my bed, patient and waiting.
They had towering shoulders, reaching toward the ceiling,
Scraping against the plaster.
Not wearing the long robes I had imagined,
Naked in their darkness.
Their bodies emaciated, legs as thin as a child's,
Fragile yet unyielding.

Child, I am unable to see their faces,
Though I strained my eyes.
In a daze, I murmured that I was afraid,
words caught in my throat.
I saw my mother's terrified face,
pale as moonlight.
I knew she could see them too, the shadows.
She could see them when no one else would believe.

My grandmother is wielding a knife,
slashing at the empty air in the living room,
Fighting unseen enemies,
The shadows didn't turn their heads.
The shadows just stood by my bed, unwavering in purpose.
They formed a circle around me, a tight circle.
The television played children's series,
But the music in their mouths gradually elongated,
What I heard, distorted and twisted.

Like the shadows on the wall,
The shadows growing heads where none should be.
Turning, revolving,
Walking to my bed with determined steps.
It straddled my body, crouching, heavy as stone.
Let us for now forget this is real,
Though memory persists.

I can see them, now, their faces,
I can see their faces emerging from darkness.
They grip the railings, bring their heads close to my pillow,
Breathing coldness. It is warm, I bat.
I look at their faces, they truly have faces,
They truly have faces that shift and change.
A kind of sorrowful black and cruel blue,
Colors that speak of ancient pains.

I think know who they are,
I don't know if ghosts exist, yet they remain,
I look at the shadows' faces, which reflect like mirrors,
and see only my reflection, staring back at me.

Candle

Flicker, candle, dance and glow,
How you move like waves that flow.

You're but a fire soul in chains,
Yes, you are listening to my pains,
I have no one to confide,
Keep my anxious fears inside.

Watch my child, today, I did,
Eyes fixed, far away, outside.
He weeps, laughs with glee,
Leaping, running, wild and free.
Heaven!
Who knows what's in his sight!
You know, dear, I am on his side.

Stream flows silent in the moonlight,
Nothing there but water quiet.
You understand me, candle dear,
He has no one for his tales,
Yet his chatter never fails.
Has my child, through all these years,
Built up any friends that aren't here?
I cannot believe, I cannot bear.

Candle bright, I cannot hear,
Friends for him should not appear.
He must lie! in this grand town,
Village child of low renown,
Cannot flee his birthed-in fate,
Must learn caution, must learn hate.
Fox-like, wary, always scared,
Friendship's price cannot be spared.

(In whispered tone —) from outside.

Candle! Look!
Outside they stand!
I've watched long, you know,
I am not crazy.
They must hear my words tonight.
People are real in pale moonlight!

Candle soul, your dancing form,
Why should freedom be your norm?

While I watch with bitter eyes,
Someone else's child nearby.

(A cry—) The candle dies.

World finds peace in darkness deep,
This is what all souls would keep.

Lowborn, wicked, fade from sight...
Peace at last, through the darkest night.

The Observer

Every morning, lunchtime, afternoon, and evening,
I stand behind the window watching my neighbors,
my subjects of observation.
I watch them eat, dance, laugh, and shout,
I witness arguments, lies, betrayals, and scandals.
I see oppressed adults, wounded children, dying old,
Lives that seem beautiful, stories that are suppressed.
I make faces at the children, then watch them run away in fright,
My heart cannot suppress a grin.
I am the observer's eye,
I always stand behind the window,
Or beneath your balcony high.

I see the fake flowers by the partition door,
I know now this is the time.
Dust, cracked plastic shoe racks,
Hope and love no longer protect this family tight.
I linger by the window, turning my eyes,
Not letting go of anyone in the room,
My observed world.

At night, children lie in bed, without parents' kisses,
I watch them, the pale face shows no expression.
Is it because they haven't been hurt?

Or because they don't know what life is?
How dare they share this same beautiful world with us?

I am the observer, I watch all this happen.
We stand outside the window,
Watching mothers look puzzlingly at their child.
He says he can see us, dear baby,
Who knows, we certainly exist.
We stand in the sunlight, not in the shadows.
We are neighbors, teachers, passersby,
Where do you think we truly sit?
We are here, there, everywhere.

We stand in your shadows, we stand in children's hearts,
You don't need to join, nor need to accept supervision.
We know, you were born to belong among us,
Not family, but friends. Not school, but freedom.
Observers, we'll meet in the new world together.

Going Home

More than once, I told my father, I was afraid to go home.
I have to pass through fences that only thin children can squeeze through,
Walk through dense forests, and paths between fallen trees.
At dusk, around five-thirty, there are no streetlights, no bricks on my path,
No small paths with barking dogs.
Each time, my heart races wildly.

Sweat soaks from my head into the back of my fur coat, my clothes.
I can't even hear the sound of the running stream ahead.
The dense forest Is like tall, pitch-black shadows, clinging to roadside stations,
Avoiding all roadsides, walls, and streetlights along the streets.
There is only fear here.

They seem to stand in the forest,
Watching me go home, go to school,
Day after day, from morning till night,
Lurking in the darkness to observe me.

More than once,
I've brought it up with my mother, but she only let me shut up,
Talking about imaginary friends, psychological problems,
Puberty, rebellion... I know it's not like that.
They're just there, watching my parents argue.
I've talked with teachers about it.
In return, there's always a lesson:
I'm sick, I can't see them, I have a mental illness.
I repeat, repeat again, repeat to myself, this is not real.

Father told me that my mother is already sick, mental illness.
She stares at the candle fire and talks to herself.
As soon as they face each other, they argue.
I hide in the next room, against the wall.
I hear them blaming each other,
I hear shouting and cursing.
Then it suddenly ends.

They come out holding hands,
But there are no expressions on their faces.
So calm,
Quietly looking at each other, mechanically walking out.
Mother walks to the kitchen,
Brings out the dinner she's prepared.
Father sits on the sofa,
Opening the tattered, grasp newspaper next to him.

The shadows,
They stand outside the window.
I shouldn't have seen them.
They observe everything.

There's no sound at dinner.
I want to ask, but I don't dare.
I'm not allowed to make any sound.
Whatever follows is training, shaming,
Saying I shouldn't be like a pig, making sounds,
Being like country folk, farmers.
I don't dare to go home, I don't want to go home.
I walk on the path between the trees.

This road is extremely long.
I hear singing coming from the forest.
My grandmother once told me,
Those children who walked into the deep forest never came back.

I look back, there's nothing,
Except for those eyes.
I know they are there.
Here.

Side

(Side of the stage)

We have no name. You are our name.
Virtual beauty, tear them down, for the world.

(Tag behind the bathroom door)

The world is beautiful, they are, we are not.
No savior, no god, no…

(Arriving at school early, there's a note on the chair)

We are looking at you, there are no secrets here.
Put down your worries, take a good look at yourself.
Discern truth from lies, we bring to you,
Leave school, leave family, for dreams.

(Broadcast, playing at the school entrance)

Trust the government, trust the school,
Trust the science, trust the society.
Be loyal to parents, be loyal to teachers,
Be loyal to leaders, be loyal to the country.

(Voice from somewhere unknown)

Hope waits there, call it what you will,
I brought a flower from the real world,
No fake smiles can be found here.

We hold each other, we laugh together,
Joy from the end of time, so beautiful,
Join us, come to the new world.

(On the way home)

Join us. Join us. Join us.
Join us! Join us! Join us!

Join Us

We are them,
We come to lead you away.
Escape your family, leave the school.
Join us.

We see,
The dust in the window sills, in the crevices.
We see the fake flowers in front of your door,
The lies your parents tell after fighting.
We see the light in your room,
The night sitting on your bed with no bedtime stories.
We see you sitting in the corner of the classroom,
No friends, no companions.
We see you being abandoned, being left alone.
We see your confusion, your struggles.
We say,
Join us, walk out the door.
Here, no one forces you to believe,
Everything in this world is beautiful.

You, us, them, smile.
Let the world feel goodness,
Goodness comes from separation,
Separation heals pain, brings freedom.

We come to your side.
We know you've seen us.

We are not them.
You will see, on street billboards,
On bathroom door advertisements,
On paper strips in your bookshelf.

Feel our power,
Listen to your desires.
Break down, then rebuild.
Create, you, their world.

Hope

Hope is right here, call it what you may,
I've brought a flower from the real world today.
No pretended smiles in this, our place, no way.

We gather and laugh with joy in our hearts,
From broken pieces, happiness starts.
Finding ourselves in this world anew,
Letting go of pain we once knew.
See the people waiting just outside?
They're waiting for you,
go to the new world beyond.

Like magic from a flower, spirits fly,
Angels with shining wings light up the sky.
You hear the whispers, you see the tears.
Watchers stand outside, filled with fears.
Why do they doubt? Why can't they see?
The hope and salvation that's meant to be?

Come with us now, relax, we'll care for you so,
When your wings come off, all troubles will leave.
In our safe haven, world, so nice and true,
Sing your dreams softly, let hope shine through you.

Window

I think my wife has gone crazy. Recently,
She keeps emphasizing what they are watching outside the window.
They? It's truly laughable, what "they" and "us"?
Another reason for your lies? I thought,
I check every day, the surveillance cameras in each room,
Nothing is there.

Outside the window is complete silence, not a sound,
Peace, with black that has no shape, form, or substance.
Nearby trees casting shadow of leaves,
Distant houses with dimmed lights.
Yet she claims she can hear singing?
Blowing the cold wind,
I can't hear anything outside.
She must be crazy.

My son told me he saw many people beside the path,
In the forest, many eyes looking at him, behind the trees.
I dare not believe it,
What has that crazy woman taught him?
What trees, what people?
There are no trees on his way home, no small paths.
He must have wandered off somewhere to play, then lied.
That crazy woman birthed nothing but a worthless, lying brat!
I look outside the window, what's wrong with this family,
what is actually outside that makes them so worried.

They? They.
Who are they?
Heavens, who are they!

Manifesto

The world begins to tremble unevenly,
In my eyes, vision falls upon the screen, up and down,
White noise, black ink spots, and spaces —
Between characters in Roman type, pristine.

The movements, shifts, right front of my eyes.
It should remain silent, fall, down, quietly,
Like that striped woolen coat on the chair,
It kept not standing tall without the touch.

The page edge disappears roundly,
In this hurried, chaotic sway of his melody.
Being worn away, or perhaps it shouldn't be called music,
Just movements at play.
Certainly being seen, only enduring in silence,
Repeatedly without end, anyway.
The edge outside the screen is cut, the sharp edge,
Slightly compressed, deformed in bend,
Yet on the white wall,
The traces of light lines can still be clearly observed.

A white flame within the black noise, jumping up and down,
Is a declaration that comes with life from the inanimate,
Inorganic, non-renewable, natural world.
The firelight illuminates you and my face, just quietly watching,
Then chaos occurs in everything that happens,
Growing as it grows.

Seeing words float before our faces,
Passing by our sides, in our hearts.
Not forbidden to find one's own declaration,
Nor wanting to just whisper in your mind.
I want to see the world here,
In all its glory, great, plain.

Trash

Always, they say culture flows like a river,
Where they savor each glistening drop,
Reflecting the world's countless tales,
crystalline and translucent.
I am a piece of trash floating on the current, for decades,
Stubbornly insoluble.

My body, molecular structure, unyielding, born of society,
Of machines, of humans, of beds, of hands and pens.

My shell, a transparent membrane, crimson,
Emerald hues dissolving in boundless waters, swirling, foaming.

I do not ask to be picked up,
Only to be glimpsed alongside others at the edge of fishing nets,
Existing without purpose, in the most common place.

Created alongside countless others,
Without remarkable tale or history,
Awaiting children's curious hands to lift treasures from the depths,
What remains visible is only industrial failure,
Cast away, mechanically retrieved.
Worn by fingers until colors fade to whispers,
Or scorched by relentless sun until all living traces vanish.
That is life.

They stand in appreciation of sweat beneath —
My form and the drops that flowed through my hands.

Siren

I hear from afar,
The siren breaks the city apart.
My heart suddenly wrapped in blood vessels,
flooded with fires, my brain goes wild.
Breathing in the ice-cold air, night,
Burnt aftermath, staring blankly.
I said thank you for my safety,
At this moment, I can hear the siren.

I think again, distant plains,
Under the endless streetlights, grown.
You can't hear any sound, at eight, at night.
Only on screens, children laugh, sad.

Imagined as prayer, waiting in silence,
To be devoured by wolves in the valley.
Behind closed doors, children's hands reach —

Toward the light of the door.
Shadows rushing toward each other, I see,
Mouths wide open, waving arms, chasing, running.
They cry out silently,
Jumping, howling in a night without sirens.

I can still stay calm, can still hear,
I feel the outdoors, from the dark,
The wind carrying children's dreams, echoes, happiness.

I know the sirens dance between belief and hope,
Lingering by my ears,
Rising like mist from the depths of the waiting hearts.

I know the sirens sweep from valleys to plains to seabed,
bringing peace.

The Age of Secrets

In ages past, in times long ago,
Before spider-folk and lunar myths were drawn,
No prisons held us, no debates were born,
Of politics dressed in science or fictional form,
Earth stood round, Roswell's tales forlorn,
While earthquakes and tsunamis remained true,
Nothing is wrong, sworn.

That was an era free from secret's hand,
Where night brought silence across the land,
Not screams and dread that now command,
In daylight hours filled with tales unplanned,
Leaving us to question if human, we still stand.

Are you human? No? Am I?
I am human. Or not?
You are not human. Maybe, who knows.

God's traces have become wind in your stories,
In this age where everything is a secret,
An age without secrets.

Private Sky

A voice comes down from the cloud,
I listen quietly, the gate closes behind.
Standing here, watching the still, delicate blue sky.

Until a guard who wears a reflective vest,
Appears behind. He waves,
"You cannot take photos here."

"This is a private place"
I stand on the street, listening,
He yells that this place is private.
I look toward the clothing stores on both sides,
They watch me from behind their windows,
"Arrest me then, please,
For taking photos under the sky."

Standing there, watching the running clouds
And the flowing, lazy people, the street.
I face the guard, smiling,
I know he has no gun in hand.

What he wears at his waist is called awkwards,
What he wears is the authority called private,
For this place,
He shouts at me, swinging his hand,
I smile back, without uttering a word.

Laughter escapes from the shadows like bats.
A couple, now shooting photos through the glass windows,
Displaying intimate postures in this place.
He quickly walks away, then, to shout at them,
Under this private blue sky.

Umbrella

Repeatedly remind me to bring an umbrella,
You say it often rains here. It will rain,
Although I haven't encountered one yet.
Throughout the year,
I may only unfold it three or four times.
While my drawer is filled with those plastic covers.

It rains often,
I often encounter such questions.
As if I don't belong to their world.
I'm someone who prefers to stay indoors.
I often see it, inside, but it doesn't come to me.
I sit in the back. In cafés, classrooms, at home.
Not often, and not willingly,

Walking in the rain,
Experiencing the freedom of wind and rain.
After all, why,
Must one suffer in the cold and damp,
To cleanse pain, or to seek attention?
To be in a moving atmosphere, to blend in,
To receive comfort and embrace,
The umbrella, why unfold it after all?

If unfolding it brings protection,
Why use the body to endure,
To defend such coming from the natural world.
You say, what you want to do is protect, not harm.

Would you call it a gift, or punishment?

The Barn

Passing by a patch of land, like similar farmland,
Yellow and green.
Similar houses, washed away by wind and rain.
The same bonfire, a dog,

A tractor, sunset,
No people, no shadows, no smoke.

Taste a mouthful of homemade food's fragrance,
Watch transparent bubbles rising from the bottom of the glass,
Go to the long-illed beds, in company without months.
Let people look at that tasteful life under sun,
Or perhaps the same, square building.
Some call this the barn.
Around it is iron skin, blue and gray paint,
With a hint of rust showing through the trend.

Everything is as usual,
Like it has been for several centuries,
Ever new, as old.

Gazing, with a few minutes of trance,
The long wait has not yet been compensated with a moment.
While goats raise their hooves,
Hear maturity calling on the plains,
Cows lower their heads, waiting for the train to pass.
Clicking sounds, passing by, that piece,
A space surrounded by barren lands.

Only in moments of approach,
Between illness and whispers,
Those fish, sunken, in space.

Pockets

Walking quarter of the way, dream not yet awake.
The world has quietly slid into the pocket.
Our retro trends go back, to 2000, the beginning.
A giant brain, shrouded in pockets, wandering,
Our thoughts, in darkness, grow, prominently,
Like potatoes germinate in the refrigerator, until next open,
Without remorse, think, how to pinch off your personal life,
After all, impossible to change, it's a dream.

In the park, chess games will never cease,
Aged hands constantly searching in their pockets,
Always, fail to grasp anything but hands.
All sweaty, dripping,
It would never mold, if washed meticulously.
Children pick up soil from the ground,
Tear open flowers.
Small birds being caught, tight, hold,
Stuffing all the beauty before sunset, into pockets.
Looking back anxiously in all directions, them, I can see.
Disappear into the depths of small alleys, then,
flowing with people, be the crowded,
Appearing, but memories of only decades ago,
Not knowing where to categorize them,
Knowing what to do, to put back,
Hands in my pockets.

I watch calendars, as the world is printed into.
Same time, New walls are erected, in the park.
Cats and dogs are all tucked away into pockets,
Countryside and wilderness, the forests, never come back,
Let's pack them all away.
Until it transforms into yet another world.
With only half the value as justification, evaluation,
The sole essence drifts further and further from its original material,
And own pocket.

A new world, now, in yellow and green,
Our hands gave the Earth a uniform haircut.
Emptying my pocket, only a sock, found,
It is also a pocket, inside,
This way, it can dance together with the children,
with my hand.

Room

(1)

March, three months, another, and after.
Empty rooms within empty rooms,
Obtained a bored person,
And a table of mineral water bottle caps.
Expired letters in the wardrobe,
No signatures and there will be no reply,
Probably because they are already dead, after I tried.

Unopened clothing packages at the bottom of boxes,
And garbage bins filled with plastic forks from instant noodles.
Wounds untended, unseen by all,
Idle soul, drifting without purpose,
Barren rooms, no spirits to share this life.

Entering and leaving at will,
Stains on the floor, tape marks on the wall,
Unwashed bowls and cups set aside day after day,
The room, you can no longer be clean.

(2)

Wiped over and over again,
Adding gentle wounds,
No one will care that dust is picked up, then falls.
Just like this cycle, from now on, only in never out.

In a room about to die,
Only for newcomers to enter, pass, and die.
Without any thoughts, through the only window,
To see the connection to the living world.
The city is full of people and rooms without people.

Room, how should you let people see,
The world is not all your fantasy.
Why are you staying here,
Watching people come and go,

leaving only disgusting scars.

What have you gained,
Just continuously losing.
People think you've gained beauty, gained money.
What do you want, what would you need?
I quietly lie on your body,
And listen to what you say.

I heard heartbeats from the concrete walls,
In one's twenties, with the fatigue of middle age.

(3)

You looked down and saw your own corpse,
I saw it, already, I am certain I have seen it,
I believe.....

I lie on your corpse,
Thinking of your heartbeat.
You once had countless dreams like me,
Until trapped to death under this patch of public sky.

In this solid, compacted forest.
I sit on your arm and write everything down.
I am about to leave, leaving you here to rot,
To grow again, watching people walk toward death.

Dismembered limbs piled on the streets,
With remaining fingers, pointing,
At the sky and buildings that inspire infinite imagination,
In a view that no one sees,
Seeing the world that everyone has seen.

The White Tree

(1)

On the yellow fields, alone, stands a white tree.
Leaning against the black mountains,
Proud and tall,
grasping the sky, feeling free,
Looking at my eyes, you refuse to fall.

It whispers boasts that drift to me,
"Please, let me try,
I can be a tree..."
Clearly, I am yellow, through,
hidden among yellows that I always knew.

I told many people, they only said,
"It's just a pole, common, undone."
Can I not distinguish white from sky?
Surely they are wrong in what they swear,
I sit beneath the white tree,
Who separates me from the pure world, and say.

"I don't want to talk to you anymore."
You turn away toward a distant space.
Without any cloning eyes, no expression on your face,
Only by my mouth, the white trunk remains,
separated from the black nights.

A piece reflects in the wind.
“Forget the end.” Someone said.

(2)

The piece of footprint of the wild man,
Or his name is “Bigfoots.”
He turns back with questions on his fingers,
Asking why I haven't begun my search for truth.
Even with believing voices that echo and fade,
I cannot turn my body,

rigid and afraid.

"Leave, please," no words fly,
With no one untouched by time,
I mutter to the person beneath the tree,
Nothing worth giving him a try.

But behind me, now,
no watchful eyes remain from.
I gaze down at my feet where shadows around,
White soil, and black wood chips,
A testament to what time slowly strips.

I hear the children's voices,
Floating from afar,
Talking of the white tree like a distant star.
They too grew up listening to the same,
Discussing with their parents without fail,
The legend of this yellow earth below,
And the white tree that continues to grow.

When the sky is no more than memory,
When black deepens into mystery,
Perhaps it has already turned to blue,
As yellow spreads behind me, ever,
As the white tree is always new.

Free.

Farewell

This is their world, after all,
where I once came, and then decided to leave.
I once approached the center, only hearing their voices.
I once felt isolated, confused,
But eventually found peace within the distance.
Confined beneath this vast sky,
I, therefore, should begin to say goodbye.

I have found my origin, my place,
And thus I journey toward future adventures.

I affirm that many people I will surely never see again,
So, there is no need to even begin these farewells.
Perhaps, in the minds, we hope to preserve —
Our best selves In that final, fleeting moment of meeting.
Many will inevitably leave or forget,
Silently forget to say goodbye.

Meanwhile, I walk a path lined with fresh flowers,
Steadily meeting what comes ahead,
Looking back only to leave behind one thing,
the solitary journey through their world,
Letting everything gradually say farewell,
In the passing of time, never to meet again.

Past successes, future hopes,
Must all bid farewell, one by one,
Until the day comes,
When you rack your brains but cannot recall my name,
Then, return as a complete person,
And in that moment, we shall meet again.

Bless You

River

I pick up the pen
Which they say this will cause the drain.
Down the drain, to drop the brain,
And save the knife, to the end.

With all the art, in my diary,
They opened your mind.
Take fragile pieces,
Fly to the air,
Write down all the answers just for real.

We're gonna find, the place of your will,
Life never tie, instead, words forever die.

Within the pen, You are ever mine.
Dream a diver, on a noiseless land,
Again.

Ears

Skin brushing against plastic, then the luminous floor,
Gray spots pulsing, dancing along familiar streets, across length.

To my left, she hides her ears under cascading dark hair,
On screen the music plays, fingers glide across vinyl and needle, digitised.
My eyes capture your absorption, illusion, silently playing on.

Passion drives those fingers, tapping rhythmically on tabletop,
I must forget the distant reciting voices that call,
A casual glance transforms into lingering tender gaze.
Years ago I ceased hearing their stories, their thoughts,
Oh, young ears, what sounds can you perceive that I cannot?

Once enamored, blocking out the rhythm,
Indulging in echoes, remaining detached.

Until all emotions whisper to me, numb in this space between us,
Likely I'll wait in vain for her to turn back, though we share this tedium, this noise,
Perhaps I shouldn't bow my head, but simply watch until everything at peace
—-everything vanishes.

Kite

A shadow hides into the city light,
No longer finding him in the night.
Footprints across the waiting face,
Passing distances,
Across boundaries, to your space.

Your gentle touch arrives on him,
Turned aside with a thoughtful whim,
And, in my gaze, catch the eyes,
Which feels so grim.

Paintings and pens lie by my head,
Truth wanders into dream paths ahead.
Soft whispers from the confidants I've left,
All transformed to your form, as he said.

Your figure shows then fade,
During the night.
Lovely, and still,
I've blowed in the wind,
Like a copy-paste piece in peace.

Gentleness

A gentle breeze comes softly, brushing past my ears,
It brings sunlight, filtering through my eyes.
Under the night sky, I, dummy, so,
Groping around, I desperately crawl on the ground,

Searching for branches, stones, pens,
To record a moment's memory and names.

Hoping in vain, regretfully,
They are battling with stars, I smelled
Until that gentleness pricked by blood falls —-
into eternal sleep. Satisfied.

When shirts are dyed as white as thighs,
The courtyard's willows still stand guard,
Black dirty water under the shadow of brick walls,
Standing, squatting, kneeling, crawling,
Guarding the days of emasculation,
With their traces already hidden in perfection.

Nowhere to search, dancing with the wind,
For the cleanness, alone, suicide.
I can't help but shield your eyes,
Ears, mouth, nose.

Don't breathe those desperate words.
I don't want to see sadness shatter your gentleness,
Throwing it to the ground, together with the garbage ash under the eaves.
This sky doesn't belong to you, past and future.

Imagine, sitting on that bus full of fresh travelers.
Don't stop, just remember, You are gently embraced.
The threads that continue on your body,
Someone should tell you,
You are no longer the kite in my hand,
Please forget to pretend you are still living in the sky.

Telecine

The shape formed by a group of cats —
can tell you the dog's name.

I don't want to say this is a frog,
Green has already become the answer, instead.

The desert grows larger, the brain grows smaller.
Thinking becomes the burden of your farewell.

Unable to pick up flowers and wine,
The pen I put down now turns into your food.

Childhood letters have no marked price to meet.
Therefore, memories also have no expiration date.

Beloved

Within the blue reflections of the glass cabinet,
There stands that golden figure, metallic,
Embracing the one, is loved.
Love's whirlpool, crimson-stained,
Washed with blue after twilight falls,
Inanimate, like flower petals scattered at one's feet.
Eyes closed, leaning against the lace curtains behind.

The metal crown atop resembling a cone,
subject to geometric constraints,
Iron threads sunset-tinged with copper oxide,
Standing upon the grassland.
Holding the beloved, I ask you,
Where does love belong?

A hand-sketched map on the wall,
Allegheny River to the left,
Written in a trembling script,
marks the place of your existence.

Head turned in longing,
the tractor's open cover bathes in fading light,
Garden soil seeps through glass bricks,
falling in gentle waves,
Revealing cracks where sunlight spills,
too luminous for mortal eyes,
The lingering love,
flowing endlessly where hope slowly descends.

In the Sunlight

My gaze drifts over one who sleeps in calm repose,
Beyond the chairback, there, I see those hands unfold.
In golden sunlight, like polished jade that glows,
Exuding cloud-soft grace and tales that books have told.
Red hair that weaves between the strands in flight,
Pink-blushed cheeks, and eyes that hold your soul, is black.
Time traveling by, ticking away, breaks the ride.

The train rests still at Lewistown, this afternoon,
A woman clothed in crimson clasps her child's small hand,
Standing patiently on the platform,
breathing the wind, as my train pulls away,
Plastic buckets by the tracks, in sunlight's spread,
Basking in that same tender gaze so bright,
And winds that through book pages gently fanned.

The city masks its longing behind patches of green,
Awaiting sunlight's touch, where children stay and play.
Shadows retreat as moments hold their way,
In soft breezes, warm hands linger yet unseen.
At last, we stop to draw a breath of light,
Our lungs fill slowly, making silence speak and praise.

Two people, still and silent in the sunlight.
Breathing, asking the same question.
Our bodies immersed deep within the light,
Like fish that breathe while watching falling rain.
Where I already forgot your smile and face,
Perhaps you need to think once more
About why We turn to each other at the same moment,
Nothing said. Nothing sad.

Silver-Tipped Shoes

I feel the sharp gaze from across the room,
Breaking my quiet like a sudden boom.
Silver-tipped shoes, shiny and bright,
Catch my eyes with their gleaming light.

My feet shift while sweat rolls down,
Silver-tipped shoes make me frown.
Hair sticks to face, shoulders slump low,
Silver-tipped shoes put on a show.

Like disco balls that spin and shine,
Silver reflections, yours and mine.
My fingers fidget, tap, and scratch,
Eyes fixed on your face, thinking, yearning,
Silver-tipped shoes, impossible to ignore,
Did they hear the teacher's call?
Whuuu , Who knows.

They don't look back, they never do,
The silver-tipped shoes so shiny and new.
Words repeat like a broken toy,
Silver-tipped shoes bring little joy.
I try to read, I try to learn,
But to your silver color, my eyes return.

I repeat their name mechanically,
Scratching, shifting, forward, back,
left, right, oh, silver-tipped shoes.
With their dazzling silver,
I cannot help —-
Cannot wait to see your true color.

Feet

(1)

In a distant, distant nook,
There stands a house to look.
Where patient observers stay,
They use the scopes day by day.

Study footprints of birds in the snow,
Decoding scripts that never meant to show.

(2)

Along the coastline,I tread,
Through halos streetlights softly spread.
Completing rituals we've known,
All designed trilogies there shown,
Knowingly we proceed instead,
Into tales where only stars are fed.

(3)

From heights above,
unforeseen a white sock falls,
Like a shrimp of crystal sheen,
Descending with grace,
Replacing street lights' gleam,
In bridge tunnels where snow convince.

(4)

We had been watched, not by the eyes.
In this era's script we've already read.

Time accumulates high,
Like branches reaching the blue sky.
And birds stay there will never say goodbye.

Missing

White wings, dark hands,
Halos, fresh flowers, blue lotus robes,
Only a face, missing.

Colored glass, windows, cracks,
Round domes, Roman style,
Surrounded by rock, infused with faith,
From all sides.

Arranged, the missing of humanity.
Dedicated to the clearest eyes under the sun,

Bedside, worshippers at the door,
In a voice only you can hear,

Living in our solid house,
Dreaming of modern
Where art is missing.
That's it, stepping out from a classical mural.

Damp feet step into the newly plowed soil of the garden,
Trampling seeds, singing, for one's own name,
Existing for the sake of existing, emptiness,
The existence of lost faith.

Unworthy

People ask me, unabashedly,
What value I carry, what worth I hold.
Left my homeland, reached New York's shore,
Became an artist, spending more and more.
I cannot recall why I should be valued at all.

Unabashedly, they count and calculate,
From dawn till dusk, at tables they sit and wait,
You question my value, my worth you debate,
While wasting your life in this ledger of fate.
I step through the doorway, trying to escape,
You follow and ask me, what price is my rate?

Should I answer, should I not,
Should I even care?
My worth and my value—how would I be aware?

Wandering

Don't be afraid,
We're still on Earth today.
In friendly fonts, I talk to the kitten,
My phone is not a mouse going to run away.

Where do dramatic children need to be?
Where do mysterious and errors come free?
How should God protect European squirrels,
As we can see?

In silent rooms where words remain spoken,
The kitten bites the mouse, hunger awoken.

Back to the corner, he turns with nothing care.
Won't you give me any answer,
While you're standing here?

The death of the mouse.

The cat and I stood,
Then wander with nothing fair.

How

I hope to see a smile,
Yet fear it might be too forced.
Like sunshine hanging on morning trees,
No need to question its existence.
I cannot touch it, brief,
Soon replaced by its original face.

How to restrain, to stop,
The heart's pulse, emotions flowing,
Watching sunlight reflect on waves.

Is it truly warm?
I cannot touch it, I don't know.

Bottle bubbles blur my shape,
Seeing shadows of fish chasing boats,
Always untouchable, somehow.

Milk Cow Cat

Beneath night's smell,
through window walls, four squares,
My mind painted a bright cow standing there.

I approached and spoke with gentle atmosphere,
"As a cat, henceforth, your name……"
He heard, and laughed without a care.
Thank you, for your thoughts,
Please, feel free to share.

In silent library, where no readers dwell,
I drift to dreams where waters rise and fail,
Transforming mundane hours under spell,
I become a milker, raising you to tell,
"Where shall this milk now go?"
you ask and wait,
As I hold your profound fate.

Is it the wild wind that whispers verse and rhyme,
Or earth's rich soil that clothes you through all time?
Through forest paths, the wanderers sublime
Speak dreams anew, in their old stories, about boring life.

The cup's water turns to boundless sea,
The milk on lips returns the cat,
once more on this day, ordinary,
Where wonder hides in all we could see.

Symphony

Walking through the night,
Listening to symphonies played by moonlight.
Eyes tightly closed, sleeves rolled against skin,
yet vision remains clear;
Like an artist's light flickering in darkness,
Appearing then fading away —
In this vast wild world,

Has anyone truly never heard music's voice?

Never spoken its name,
Nor painted its form,
Nor written its song,
Nor imagined its grace.
Never witnessed its power unfold before their eyes,
And the endless peace.
For artists must let art dwell
Within art's sacred appearance.

Amidst meaningless landscapes —
And through literature's golden hours,
The pupil reflects another searching gaze,
As from a single patch of moonlight —
Springs forth endless colors and beauty, divine.

Now the curtain rises slowly, the drama unfolds,
With attentive stillness;
Fresh flowers lie scattered across plates,
While hands clutch desperate at napkins,
Against black tablecloth,
White linen cuts through shades of pink.
Thus suffering transforms into sustenance,
Completing the symphony,
Wrapped in quiet observation —

From the audience's seat,
imagining streetlights' glow within shadows' shrink.

Behind My Mind

Within your mind the cosmos dwell,
Beyond my form, behind me still,
Heavenly whispers, I can tell.

One summer, our paths crossed in time;
Perhaps we never truly met,
Or longer since faded from your mind.

In that place existing for me alone,
And this place you are no longer my own.

Moonbeams shine, your shadow by my side remains,
Until new life calls the Lord's name first with breath.
You, misread through a clouded gaze,
Would you share with me what life ongoing till death?

"No... thank you," I call toward distant lands,
Still, you wave from where you stand,
Your eyes fixed past me, their light no longer gleams.

On pages read before thousands times,
Now silents across through the nights.

Days without breeze, without joy, without weeping's release,
Without echoes, without thoughts that wander free,
And without your figure in the empty space I could see.

Return to home, please, I will wait in hope,
though words now fail to bridge our worlds.

Dancing Children

Blue light streams through clouds of yellow hue,
Shining on glass untouched by time's decay,
Casting shadows where power lines cut through.
White tiles stained with rusted crimson clay,
Clay that shares its tale with walls behind.
Blue dusk surrounds the ground on which I stay,
Perhaps lending my eyes a different kind.

Between white and red,
Children are dancing,
Philippines, Mexico, Italy,
Dancing among broken tiles.
Their faces in the shadows, divided,

Twisted bodies dancing, riding skateboards,
Hands that hold dancing with skill.

Their faces are blue, deep blue and light blue,
The background is the city of Picasso, peaceful,
Perhaps dancing for peace.
Impressed. Abstraction.
Their eyes look up, almost invisible,
The remaining earth, angry flames,
Pointed buildings, roaring, rhythmic.
Striped pants, checkered shirts, pointed shoes,
Suede, egg yellow, together.
Dancing forever.

I look at this painting, eyes following the dance,
Before me are candies, glass fragments, sandwich.
Together inviting my childhood.
Their hands move up and down, hanging in the air,
Whistling, rational numbness,
No one walks over to watch them dance.

Order and rational fracture, divided,
Squares, tiles, branches, broken leaves,
Dancing between lines,
Waiting for the sun to set a little more,
Clouds are saying, they will disappear, sooner.
I wait for someone to walk out.

I only saw children dancing,
No children dance. Until I leave.

Today

The moon flips, open a day,
ripples and metal kneaded into a cup,
quiet drum from my soul has delayed,
by the bed's edge, push me to a drop,
Everyone sleeps at the stop.

Crushing fragrance as it's blown,
through the skylight where no roof is known.
Heads peer over edges, playing hide to side,
their presence fleetingly among,
While shrimp floats in the sink below,
just a fork needed till dawn's light is thrown.

Toothpicks serve as hangers wide,
as fountain waters might dampen what I like,
As a result,
I jump down flicking rails so smooth and glide,
shouting in sunlight with nothing to hide.

Finger press the viewfinder with pride,
No signatures forever from sight to slide.
So replacements exist when memories arrive,
waveforms crushed in mouth as diaries alive.

Becoming lovers by the sea,
or walking to bed toward flowers and seed.
All that remains in sight are birds at sky,
And bed, and you, and me.
And cats and parks on benches beside.

Today inevitably becomes the today
after suicide and the day.

Flying Away

On the power line outside, a bird rests still,
I think it must be a sparrow,
as I sit at the restaurant's long-legged chair,
Spread butter and blueberry jam by my hand,
Upon the bread, for the share.
The sunlight renders me unable to keep gazing,
Condensation on the window slowly blinds my sight,
Brings me to another view.

The shadow of the pole stretches long on the ground,
And so the waiting souls to another world are bound.
Here at the glass façade of Blackwell Square,
Where letters and parcels rest by pipes with care.
Once I notice the blue stones and fallen leaves,
Caught in the wall's wounded corner that grieves.
Filtering time's passage, and where birds' footprints weave,
On the surface of the plain world, animals perceive.

People in sunlight, like giants finely spun,
Colors dancing near yet never joining, undone.
Golden blooms and emerald leaves play their part,
As amber light reveals all life with gentle art.
I watch in stillness as the puddle slowly disappears,
Leaving no whisper of what once was here.

They've taken flight like birds across the sky,
Years ago, such thoughts would make me shy,
Yes, they have gone, this lesson I have learned before.
Like children's balls that bounce with joyful might,
Wrapped warm in quilts, in dreams they soar in flight,
Ascending heavenward beyond our searching sight,
While we remain, on earth by day and night,
Forever standing on this world we know, as the surface,
On the right.

End, at last,
Their whispered words ring clear and true,
As skies above have cleared to perfect blue.

Perplexity

Before my eyes, is an aged face,
Hearing a youthful voice, beside my ear,
Speaking of something outdated, from his mouth,
This is a dream that puzzles a child.
A confused dream.

Upon arrival, a soundless cloud drifts by,
Through layers of fine rain and clamoring night,
Beneath the tree, transformed to shadow still,
Telling children tales of skies up high to the hill.
"Will I become a cloud when I am gone?"
The child inquires.

"Yes, indeed you will,
Everyone shall, when their time is drawn."

I watch all unfold within my mind,
Quietly flowing in the river's deep,
As time passes through me, undefined,
Turning to shadows where tree branches weep.

Until I sit listening below,
Not anyone's child as moments to know,
No interests floating where wild winds blow.
I create distance that puzzles the mind,
Hunting the clouds' young voices left behind.

At last, I leap down,
falling back to the river's embrace.
I become a leaf drifting from my body,
Offered to fish swimming in nearby waters.
Who knows where tomorrow I'll be
—beneath the tree,
Or in the heavens,
at the cloud's edge,
Or perhaps living within your voice.

In a child's dream,
Through puzzles and stories,
The answer waits.

Crown Antiques

Crown Antiques,
At 1018 Fifth Ave,
Near Duquesne University.

Don't procrastinate, its exterior maintains a golden splendor.
It has been locked up for an unknown length of time,
The entrance is piled with dust, boxes,
Our trash is their antiques,
It is existence
That proves the crown.

Photos. Glass.
Toys. Posters.
Mysterious history.

I peer inside
Through locks and railings.
Drawing near. Breathing ancient air.

The glass is sealed with dust,
The color of latex mattresses.
Walls tiled with
Small blue-green squares.
Glossy, the surroundings,
Of toilets and bathrooms,

Looking up to the second floor,
Are stacked records and CDs,
As if about to find a ripe name.

No eyes seen.
No scientists from novels. No vampires.
Nothing mysterious. Only history.

Hoping it carries
The crown,
continuing To shine.

Now permanently closed.

Drowned Spirit

There isn't a decent river in the city center,
That can wash away the thoughts and sorrows in one's heart.
Trapped at the seaside where streetlights cannot fully illuminate,
Drowned Spirit, who should hear your song?
Who would sit patiently,
On the bench to listen to your sermons?

You still linger in the streams of childhood,
Waiting for children to pass by.
Those who dive into the river for play, falling into your trap.
At the bottom of the river, you,
Were replaced by someone's spirit.
Day and night, you must stay here,
wearing down your own suit, own face.

In the words of the elders,
You once succeeded, being favored and pampered.
Then suddenly disappeared.

It seems you too forgot the depth of the river,
Surrendering beneath the rippling waves,
forgetting to lecture. As if you were still right,
Even when no one is listening,
No one is willing to approach.

The birds flying overhead,
Your silhouette absent from their eyes,
Already dead.

Drowned Spirit, you've already buried the past.
Decades ago, you could still hear children playing nearby.
Now, time doesn't return, no one visits anymore,
You have no home, no one to talk with. You must
Forever guard the river in your heart.

Young Blood

You ask me to share your pain, calling it suffering.
Accuse me of being cold-blooded,
With no heart for people and pain.
Simply, I don't want to wade into your muddy river, again.
To be infused by your stale demands, decayed,
Into the blood of the young, to keep outdated ideologies burning,
Speaking grand words that haven't left your mouth in decades,
Your world,
Pushed to the margins by others, beneath a broken sky.

Young blood has its own thoughts, even while living in your world,
Only daring to whisper at doorways, in deep night,
Or when no one is watching,
To breathe life into their own dreams.
Reaching toward the young only burns you.

Don't be afraid —
Your experience is already buried in the soil,
From which they cultivate hope:
Young blood, repairing what remains,
Mending the broken sky.

You claim it's for freedom and peace, for their sake,
But they no longer belong to you.
In their world, be silent, let go.

It's time to sleep, to return to your own dreams.
There's no reason,
To mix with the blood of the young.
You are not them, nor are you us.

The Absurd

Dancing, she dances, is the absurd, the absurd and more,
Like clouds your polished mind changes shape forevermore.
People shift names and faces as days unfold,

When I ask who they were, they turn away cold,
How impossible to guess! What do they ask anymore?

For a moment she waves feminism's bright flag,
Embracing women she claims as her own,
Pushing away those who work like men drag,
Sneering at communists with a tone.
Her father once called her a girl of the street,
Skipping her classes, with mature men to meet,
Your face—so revolting!
How impossible to guess!
Tell me now, why —
Must you dance in crowds, like clouds in the sky,
Claiming you're pure while the masses are stained?

History, chat logs—distorted mirrors, you say,
Cut off the childish past, what have you grown?
"It's gone," you declare, "let the past fade away,"
Then spin tales of your sad history—alone.
What do you want? How impossible to guess!
What should memory retain?

"Can't leave the men," you say, "so many men,"
"Not a prostitute," you claim, "just for the cash."
You want to be your words, not others' vision,
Your shadow breeds distrust, makes hopes crash.
You feel for women, then reach for their purse,
Mock their foolishness, sit with them—even worse!
You want men talking about feminism—
To hear what sound? How impossible to guess!
It's all in books you won't read — how profound!
What do you seek? How impossible to guess!

Dancing is you, absurdly you,
Your mind lost shape, ground down to rounded dots,
Needing outside points to form lines anew,
Unable to stand alone with what you've got.
When I ask your real name, I recall instead.
Cloud-stories, pure yet dirty, filling my head.

How impossible to trust!
How impossible to guess!

Traces of Healing

The statuette lies askew in the grass,
The cracks in the road mended with black rubber,
Forcing plants to surrender all their colors,
Leaving only the yellow of the aftermath.

I see what little green remains, dwells,
Lingering between the broken steps of the church,
In front of my eyes.
Like stones and nails embedded in tire treads,
Moving forward with mechanical steps,
Thrown off, leaping,
finally falling to the ground,
As if dead.

I know he still lives,
I can find that gaze in the grass, somewhere.
Recognizable at a glance, his hope brings despair.
I linger in the crosshatch of green,
Listening to children pray around, on the bed,
Longing to be heard, be healed
to be seen by him at the table end,
Until we abandon hope,
And the strength of all living beings within our grasp.

There are no answers, no choices.
When looking at children's drawings,
Scribbles growing outward from the heart, prominently,
Blue ripples and traces of sunlight, there.
Mixed with clasped hands, the parents,
Red flowers, green grass, yellow birds.
Except for you,
In a world built of botanical gardens and dinosaur museums.

No more, the lonely search, grace before meals,
No need, to go to the desert, to hear passerby’s parables,
No meaning, to wait, in taverns, for vipers,

Then, abandoning the past, yourself,
no regrets for having waited, wasted.

For truth.
Rules. Never seen.

Until truth arrives at your bed, by side,
Your mind repeats in dreams, many times.
Return, before the sacrifice that never began.
Realizing your death cannot bring smiles to the world,
People still pray, for whom, only children will listen.
Flowing by the pillow, hidden in pleasant dreams, is despair.
Before ascending to the moon, never crying.
Told me, you don't want to see anyone's tears.

I said,
I believe you,
So, I bless you,
May you see yourself,
Not as others see you.

Even as words grow from damp desire,
Embracing the goodness no one is willing to believe,
Only moldering in the shadow of the sun,
shedding the garment of honesty,
Covering you as seen by the world, without speaking.
I can certainly pretend you are still listening,
Leaning close, waiting for the wind,
to bring your voice.

There are no disciples, final,
They are still growing, and haven't yet begun to believe.
No funeral. No. Please.
Sunlight still dances across the barren ground,
The moon hasn't spoken, hasn't ceased its weeping,
Hasn't surrendered the right to wither and age,
Offering both flesh and faith to the void,
Just as you discarded yours to the wind.

Cube

Cube,
I've told you more than once,
you will never become a ball.

No matter how many times you blink your eyes,
How many times you change your face,
You can't shed those rigid, unchanging lines.
Every day you're talking, never stopping,
With those who seem straight and smart.
Ordinary, righteous,
Don't you realize they only have one face?

You say you want to change,
Frantically change, change your face,
Can't you see your six faces —
Fail to show what you truly feel?

What you want to change,
too much, but what you want to do is too little.
I stand aside, reading books,
What I think hasn't decreased at all.
Your quests swim lost in my mind's ocean,
Endless words, minimal deeds, answerless.

You're extremely anxious, restless doubt, no way to find,
Your faltering faith.
You preach self-sacrifice, for others to change to triangles.
Shed these rigid confines that bind you, please,
For you remain,
a lone point trapped in such cubicle prison,
Forever hesitating, drowning in thought while starving for action.
What you want to change, too much, useless.

Lifting your face, I don't want to see,
It is a triangle.
Why be so eager to sacrifice?
Cube, those strong eternal beliefs of yours,
Why do they become fewer and fewer as they change?
Where have they gone, to search.

You say you can't communicate with me,
Because of the ball in your eyes.
I can only say,
It’s that you refuse to see my face clearly,
See the lines at the edges, blur at night.
Forward and backward, left and right,
Don’t tell me you find nothing left —
In the light.

The Only

Eyes,
Not turning away from the phone,
Waiting for each word to appear on the screen.
Today is not the workday,
But every day is a workday for me.

On the streets, on walls, on screens,
On shoes, on the ground, on maps,
On faces, on canvases, in the sky —
Those squares,
Arranged in rows depicting all traces of life,
Growing in memory, combining into new shapes.

It is in teachers' words, the ashtray under the stairs.
It is those coffee cups looking down from the rooftop terrace,
The stains that don't move on the street.
It is the distant light on the edge of the building,
Something we can only imagine but don't know the name of,
Points of light, forever there.
They are all moving,
All capable of movement, always moving.
Never obscured by hands or clouds.

Those on the terrace,
Together with the heat from pipes,
Have already been painted, colored, named, illustrated,
Although they themselves remain colorless.

Lying asleep on the heating pad, close to the window,
One can see the temperature of those activities.

In the light,
Even when the sun is obscured,
It will forever sink down, yet it remains —
The most basic, primitive structure,
The only thing I cannot help but believe in.

Still Life

Tourist

In time, a high wall rises, a fortress is built,
Only to resist the erosion of time, the invasion of memories,
Until opening that door weathered by wind, looking inside,
There is nothing, no people or things left behind.

In the washing of sunset, returning to the small town once passed by,
That noodle shop, steam still rising from the steel pot,
A warm spring hiding underground, hearing the sound of moving footsteps,
I pull open the metal shutter door, the pale yellow wallpaper curls in time.
The shop owner, wearing white, washing a nearly transparent chef's hat,
Rising from a bamboo-woven chair, quickly walking over from across the street.
She tells me, they're no longer in business, perhaps come back next time.

I stand at the shop entrance, looking at the clock on the wall,
Pointing to five in the afternoon. Sunlight through the leaves like strung pearls,
Flickering with the yellow-green light of fireflies, I carry my luggage,
Follow the stone path, heading to the train station at the end of the main road.
There is only a high wall, white paint with yellow bricks behind,
A green iron train waiting for me, for the only tourist in time.

Dusk

Like tiny fine droplets,
The breeze lifts delicate gauze at bedside,
A blue light enters, tinged with pink and orange hues.

Through the translucent linen weave,
Etching patterns of shadow across wooden floors.

From the grass, a white-speckled cat,
Tongue stretched out, black eyes.
Shimmering with veins of green,
The only color that remains.
Among grasses, trees and parks,
Wrapped in azure shadows after sunset.

In that fleeting moment,
More than regret could ever capture.
The cat grooms its dappled coat,
Lingering in the invisible orange glow, there,
Before another daybreak arrives here.

Sleeping in

You lean against the train's side wall,
Sinking deep into slumber,
Glasses perched upon your face.
Wallet rests on the table, as the train sways to and fro,
like drifting on water, defenseless in sleep.
Your mouth slightly parts,
Breathing in dancing sunlight beyond the window,
I watch golden reeds by the water's edge,
Branches like chicken claws between them,
Holding up a misty blue sheet.

The train halts at Providence, Rhode Island, smallest of all states.
So small, Yet dreams so vast. I glimpse the station sign.
News tells of a fallen tree, Forced to linger here,
Duration unknown. I step from the station, eyes scanning all around,
This quiet town with just one breakfast place awake,
Perhaps only because it's Saturday.

I trace the map, wander through each crowded plaza,
Each street, wrapped in lethargy,
That pulls one down toward sleep; figures slouch on columns,
Against lampposts, eyelids drawn.
The sun, too, hides behind veils of cloud;
Through lenses, eyes rest on painful, wrinkled sculptures,
Lethargic souls and verdant structures.
Devotees at street corners share bread from Italy.
The town drowns in idleness and languor,
Identical block towers line the thoroughfares,
In lethargy all seems asleep.
The train dormant at its station,
Glasses still, upon the face.

Roaring

Roaring, sneezing, sobbing.

Bars crowd beneath my window on Essex Street.
"Sexes," the brothers joke, or "extra sex."
The sex I can't count, but the drunks I know well.

Half an hour now. Still coughing.
A woman's voice. Clear, drunk.
Through pipes, half-century bricks, window corners,
It reaches me. Raw, powerful, unbroken emotions.
Breaking, continuing, breaking. Now broken.
Wait until footsteps and exhaust drown it out.

What is wrong with this world?
Why is no one sleeping?
Eleven-thirty roaring,
The street below is still shouting.

Iron Nails

The neighborhood, digital elevators emerging from the ground,
Trees jutting at angles, green palms nestled between buildings,
Crevices overflowing with moss and unnamed grasses.

People resting on long chairs under the trees,
In shirts, shorts, cloth shoes, skin partially exposed.
Yellow, green, blue, oval shapes, light spots dancing,
Their forms shift with the pupils in the sunlight.

On the cracked stone path, two iron nails stick out.
The trees, visitors, homes, hills, urban landscape —
Upon close inspection, blur into the background.

This place they call Little New York, people say,
Every city has one, I know, with triangular peaks and tall buildings.
Children running in the plaza, sunset clinging to glass walls,
I peek out from under a tree, drawing back my sight, far away.

Urban Monologue

Like flowers on a balcony, I gaze at the wall.
The city's rhythm makes me feel so small.

Hides under layers of vibrant green,
A world of concrete, cold and keen.

It is red, merely red, a signal through the sprawl.
On my path to store, I was trapped in an urban hall.

The sunlight remains as tenderness shifts away,
Steps sound like pendulum marking the end of day.
Bearing the gaze from websites,
My skin turns to transparency, nothing left to say.

This city frames me in a painting,
Where everyone stood, playing the same game.
Red, green, yellow, realities we fail to name,
Colors of signals guiding us through streets the same.

We've failed to grasp any words in this city game,
And his monologue continues, without an urban claim.

Just A Sign

They say,
I'm nothing special.
Just a warning on display.
A silent metal witness to the traffic every day

My shadow falls beside me, perfectly outlined.
But no one sees the fire,
That used to burn at my core.
How do you speak to something —
That was never meant to last?
What crosses through your mind,
When our eyes meet as you drive past?

How should you talk to me?
What should you think?
You say, I'm nothing special,
Just enforcing,
All the rules you have to play.
Standing alone in silence,
While everyone just speeds away.

Fading in the sunlight,
Washed away in the rain.
So easily broken, replaced without pain.
I’m made in the factory line,
That's all the story of mine,
Just a sign.

Thermos

Although I cannot merge into your world, I stand on the table,
My hard metal interior encased in the exterior, in white.

Already bearing many scratches, born from reliance and contact,
Even fallen, I refuse to be seen as broken, asking nothing in return.

I stand on the dining table, resisting firmly, persevering,
Even as all my flaws are overshadowed by the price tag on my body.

Accepting sounds from the surroundings,
None compare to the painful sigh within me.
I know those water droplets condensing in the seal, striking my body,
But I have no choice, I still need to protect, preserve all their warmth.

Winter

Pink, slowly tears the frosted winter free,
Sugar-coated season begins to slip away.

Paint peels along the tiles you could see,
Flowing towards next spring in one day.

I wait for ages in the cracks to grow,
Together on grass, beneath the snow.
Missing you and summer's gentle glow,
Memories of our days will never go.

Sunset offers chocolate to the moon,
You speak of bread and liberty is coming soon.
Freedom found itself in a simple way,
That plays throughout eternity everyday.

I love autumn's eyes, which means you too,
The moon walks branches, crosses the pool.
No need for misty poets to pursue,
Nor love-feared warriors rush to.

Walk past the red bricks, where all has died,
To find you, when windows vanish from our sight.

Snowy County

Sunlight glides across the rooftop.
Through venetian blinds,
Light filters below, seeping onto white-painted wooden boards.
Beneath the azure sky,
The small town transforms Into an intoxicating snow country.

In childhood, I glimpsed Swan Lake,
Once dreaming, like Nils Holgersson, of soaring on wings.
Lost in thought, I sit at a white table waiting,
As power lines string fresh flowers over white houses.

Tightening, climbing upward along white window sills,
I gaze at white window frames from within.
There, in that snow-crafted house,
White daydreams unfold.
Even the shadows spilling onto the street
As I walk past, it is white, snowy.

Into every corner of sight,
Sunlight has woven white dreams.
Behind glass, everyone smiles,
waves, greetings.
Between each tile my feet skip across
Lies a blanket of white fragments.

In the distant mountains of snow county,
Fear and joy simultaneously return to their source.
Behind this ordinary window of glass,
The land beneath my feet yearns.

After Snow

I cannot say, as snow fell.

Perhaps tomorrow, ice will glaze,
As a frozen shimmer lost in haze.
Who'd say it's from the fish store on streets?

Paper scraps upon the table sway,
Dried strands of hair beside the bed remain,
Cotton filling in the quilt trash can,
And snow beyond the window's frosted pane.

After teacups empty, losses rise,
Moments slipping before our eyes.

I watch the city shrouded in the mist,
From mountains. Lights dance and persist.

Green Tea

Not until the end of the fourteenth chapter,
Did I finally break free from my ruminating thoughts,
And hear the conversations around me.

The server asked if everything was okay.
I had been eating breakfast for half an hour.

I nodded, then made myself a cup of hot tea,
Green tea.

Around me,
People were arranging their beautiful lives.
I silently hummed, enjoying the performance of —
The city's early morning calm and tranquility.

Someone said they wanted to bring tea to America,
But only offered milk.
Perhaps you should ask those British,
Whether they can accept green tea bags —
steeped in room temperature oat milk?
How absurd.

If you were to ask Chinese people that,
you'd probably get slapped!

Afternoon Nap

After lunch, at Tabetomo in New York,
A draft of Sapporo, a large serving of ramen.
From the bright bar counter,
Having finished a warm barley tea,
Holding my stomach,
I walked back along Avenue A,
And went to bed.

I kicked off my shoes, lay on the mattress,
As if everything returned to childhood,
I curled up my legs and climbed into bed.
The radio was playing
"Spider-Man, Rabbit-Man culture"
On this land with little history but abundant legends.

I imagined my grandmother sitting by the bed,
Chatting with my mother,
They told me to go to sleep.
I watched the faint light behind the curtains,

Fan blades rotating,
They closed my eyes, and fell asleep.

A few hours, or perhaps until dusk,
I woke to the aroma of dinner,
To the gentle call from my family members.
The afternoon naps of childhood beckon me endlessly.

My mind was still thinking,
Until I forgot all my childhood stories,
And finally fell asleep.

Boring Clouds

The train rushes past a curtain of trees,
A house appears, then vanishes in seconds.
Clouds drift overhead, laden with boredom,
Their shapes refuse to shift or bend.

Once he basked where sunlight flooded valleys,
Now that light can't find its way to me,
For he waits, wrapped in his boredom,
Becoming just another cloud,
Listless and free.

I sway forward, body in motion,
Backpack slung across my shoulders,
Looking up with empty eyes at those same dull clouds,
No matter time or distance traveled,
Their form remains unchanged.

They become the words I lazily compose,
Words perhaps no one will ever know,
Only in those hollow moments,
Might they be read, remembered,
Like nameless clouds drifting above,
Unknown to anyone below,
Existing or not, steeped in boredom.

I'm not a bird, nor am I fish,
Can't yearn for what nature provides,
Just lingering, bored and restless,
Dwelling in the mind where boredom thrives,
You too are just a cloud where emptiness survives.

I'm merely someone on a tedious train,
A passenger beneath the weight of boredom's reign,
With dreams as lifeless as the stagnant air,
And clouds that drift above without a care.

Might you who read these words with a heavy sigh
Become someone whose spirit learns to fly?
Be that soul whose interest never wanes,
Who finds in boredom's verse what joy remains.

Indeed, boredom.
And clouds that never change.

Platform

Midnight blue, Peter River, lightest and mair;
Moon blurs softly, impressions, beyond aware.

Searching for secrets,
from our chance, about meetings, and rebirth.

Days of calm before journey,
among the quiet mouth filled with money.
From the sky, your messages arrive.
Plush to touch, like chasing planes,
To where I can't conceive,
What I can’t derive.

With all my feathers spent,
Just a “Thanks” wanna convey.
What you expected to say,
Only, I bid farewell today.

Coin

I want to sing a song without wind,
In the moment when the coin is tossed,
Consciousness slips past sunlight and smile,
I gaze upon your face,
Until flowers bloom in the sea, the trend.

Facing the red door,
I sit in silence while strangers pass by,
Where fingertips meet shadow-cast leaves,
under rooms bathed in moonlight,
In an unchangeable conclusion,
Your breath Carves a definite distance.
The sky, collapsing,
Noise separating lips from teeth, at the ear's edge,
Seeking modern interpretation, faith and language.

Digital leaves the home,
Finally finding his earphones
In the coffee cup's embrace.

Stone Frog

Under the cherry blossoms,
Two stone frogs,
Some say they're golden toads.
I insist on calling them green frogs,
Simply because they are green in color.

They have been lying idle for long, tormented by children.
I hear the sorrowful sobbing in the wind,
Tears silently flowing in my heart,

Happiness unknowingly crushed,
Can tears flow from your eyes?

I wish the earth would gradually move away,
because of loneliness.
Wanting to be loved, not wanting goodbyes,
Until they only have silence.

The meaning of travel lies in the journey itself,
So I walked out the door,
Like many people I've seen,
Following the patterns in books, seeking dreams.
Until my tears stopped the smile,

The feeling of stopping comes from stopping,
Until the next heartbeat, letting life begin.

Yellow

Random ink, one night, fills the sky.
Afternoon, I set down my pen,
Walking into the sunset.

Looking back, I see birds by the water,
In the ripples, in the park.
Quietly watching me, swimming away.
Following its gaze,
I see into the distance,
Green temples like those in Southeast Asia.

Restaurant, or memorial hall,
Arc-shaped tiles,
Carrying traces of dust,
Melting perfectly into the green leaves behind.
Below the window, many people sit.
Their shadows stretched long,
Pulled into the evening's gentle sway.

At hand, a paper cup,
Purple tea completes a green dream,
Blue sun, red self, mine, my brain.

Early Spring

I arrived at the era, to be displayed.
Like a greeting card printed in gray dust,
playing on the shelves, faded yet stayed.

The snacks in hand, the rubber in mouth,
in the place within your heart,
value defined by material and appearance.

Growing up, not yet mature, a chapter of life.
Together with a cat,
shaped by emotions into a sphere,
transformed into daily, monthly, yearly stories.

From newspapers,
Written into memories.

Washing

At five, I get up from the boat, washing;
Seven, washing, waking up, washing.
Getting out of bed, washing.

When water flows over my head,
In the bottle, from the sky,
The clear water gently drips, dripping,
Warm all the way to my toes,
Touching my entire body, waking up, washing.

Going out, washing; back home, washing;
Eating, washing; sleeping, washing.
Today, washing; tomorrow, washing.

Washing.

Third Three

I pull up winter, from bed,
The air conditioner walks beyond quilts.
March has arrived,
While three souls share one dwelling,
It’s the third year in New York City,
For me.
As I lift the third cup of morning tea,
Beside my mouth,
Honey sweetens the pages in my hands.

Performance,
as the third party, an observer of the world.
Giving up happiness, for just three coins,
And trading them for a sliver of chocolate cake.
I wander hesitantly, unable to cross thresholds,
yet trying once more,
Drawn into swirling patterns etched across the sealed cover,
Which whispers another tale of eternal youth,
The third chapter of three.

Through three failed worlds past,
As the Mayans foretold.
Once again, we dismissed the third world's endless prophecy,
Suspended in this third state between past and present,
Was the arduous path merely to discover... three?
My watch shows three marks quickly passing,
Fifteen minutes still to wait,
In the laundry room.

Three washes,
To sustain one month.
You, three weeks, my three years.

Black Paint

From birth, we have been wearing it,
Protecting our souls, immortal yet unfading.

I look at the woman in the painting,
The body, against a blue-brown sky,
She wears a white dress that trails down to her heels,
Masked, with that face of deepest black.

Black hands forming traces of cats and snakes,
Fingernails like proofs of geometry and mathematics,
Like some children claimed.
Between the face and body, one can clearly see,
There exist towering palm trees beneath spring light,
Red flowers are blooming,
And skin as profound As white shirts,
And western trousers that embrace the form.

"Come see what they have done,"
The mask speaks unbidden.
"Come witness with your eyes what hands have wrought,"

Again and again, like earthworms emerging from soil,
ceaselessly repeating.
Have you ever heard the laugh of earthworms?
In their dark domain?
Laughing, crying, shouting.

He tells,
Do not fantasize about the sweet fragrance of soil and grass.
The time has come to truly see what they have done,
The mask urges without rest,
"Behold how they are adorned with wigs,
Draped in flags, painted with false colors, and..."

"What?" I circle to the back of the canvas,
Gazing upon that pure, innate whiteness that remains.
"Nothing has changed—it is white,
Eternally white."

"SHUT UP!"
The mask cries out, "You! You filthy racist!
Inferior, slave from the third world's margins!"

Suddenly the voice falls still,
Silence becomes merely a mask once more.
I stand there motionless, saying nothing,
Nothing done.

I observe the cracks where paint has dried upon the mask,
Those colorful decorations, poorly glued, soon to fall—
Transparent shimmering plastic pieces catching light.
Beneath all this shines dazzling white,
with nowhere to hide.

Always in silence,
I reach to touch my face,
Knowing a mask rests somewhere there.
Though unseen.
Even if I cannot feel it or know its true color.

I imagine It must be covered with the dust of years.
All around me, others wear masks of black,
At least what they acknowledge as official, academic,
Specific black, yet also varied hues and shades.

"What black? Who speaks of blackness?"
I watch the black mask as it roars these words at me.
"This is dark brown," He declares.

The rest I cannot hear clearly,
Dark brown is not black, and so on—
This I already know.
Here is not the first time,
Where such words have been spoken.
As for now, I dare not call it black anymore.
It is not that I cannot see or distinguish.
In front, what lies before.

They have woven black into the city, embedded it in fairy tales.
Until no one can discern what is truly black or white. No longer.
Children smile with stiffened lips, shaking their heads,
Declaring their love for black, for world, for love itself.
Even the whiteness they now call black:

Pearl white, ivory white, white hair, feathers—
Until this world contains no genuine black at all.

The lighthouse beam still cuts,
Through the blue sea's darkness.
Future travelers who struggle to find their way.
Yet the shadow between mask and body remains covered,
Which is called white in meaning,
Where is hidden from view in dictionaries.
Becoming "black" only,
Because its name is no longer called "white."
Mask said.

Night Light

I close the door, turn on the night light.
The night is too dark, the window's glare too bright,
Awakening the bedroom door from slumber light.
I become the sole being in this confined space,

A living creature, wrapped in blackness complete.

Like a jellyfish drifting through deep sea waters,
Or some self-illuminating creature unnamed,
A fish they call "mysterious" in nature's quarters.
It savors the field of vision slowly claimed,

While music dims the heartbeat's steady pace.
Those distant murmurs return to the ear,
Consciousness finally surrenders to grace,
Relaxed. Like sugar after coffee, clear,

Worth savoring slowly. Pouring. Released.

Ghost

Upon the prairie, here, zebras bend and tear,
Their breast, born from light, common and ordinary.

Fractured skies loom where clouds despair;
Sun pierces moon, ghosts lose their names in diary.

From jagged peaks do giants shattered gaze,
While dwarves below in broken wonder pause;
What fragments drift behind their eyes' maze,
None speaks, as through the void they clutch at straws.

To me, their severed hands reach through the boring life,
In layers tone, vision splits apart, colors stay alive,
Vast oceans where the spectral remnants drift.

Through cracked glass mirrors caught by chance,
There is the star, who claims as a start:
The prairie, sky, or face in disrepair?
Finally, eyes dissolved in darkness' snare, reveal.

Photo

Many people walk down,
over the sake of my head,
On the white wall ahead, I see
smiling faces with urban minds.

Next to the yellow crying face,
A "Thank You" speaks.
Silence remains, here he has
no chance to say any words.

Streets still overflow with hurried guys,
In the hallway, you could find
a dog in rain and plastic seats.
The wax-yellow light at the end conceals in 80s,
Dragging on the ground,
visible yet invisible essays.

The child sits alone on hillsides,
weeping in the sunny day, where
watching distant valleys and trains
filled with cargo and delay.
You smoke in the carriage, is black,

Without any claim, finally
Lost in thoughts with no purpose,
and no name.

The hillside grass with smiles that will never delay.

Carelessly you and white smoke,
Frozen in black and peace, while
The overturned glass has lost in the sun's behave.
Our hands conformed to nets, until the moonlight
comes as our best friend, and says.

Hello, Yes, Goodbye.
OK. Again.

When all that remains is a photo,
Then nothing truly remains at all.

Feather

I look at myself in the mirror,
Teardrops sliding down my cheeks.
Above, impossible to ignore,
White hair at twenty-one years.
For this age,
I cannot disregard the sign,
As I stand before time's passing once again.

Time's rhythm halts in silence,
Like that lone white feather
On a rooster's tail in twilight.
Colorful white among many hues,
Gently falling, then mud-stained,
Turning to a dull yellow, at the end,
This is what I witnessed in childhood.
I saw, white to yellow, deep,
So, it becomes black.

To be honest, I believe it,
Though my mother does not.
White hair comes too early for my age.
What should I contemplate? Say.
What experiences have I gathered?
Think. Defending against my own aging,
As if needing to prove some worth
Knowing early decline means
Either falling into sewers
Or remaining beside the pillow on my bed.

White feathers descend from the sky.
I know they will soon change,
Turn black, drift white, to,
A fleeting moment of purity.
Until white becomes a spectrum of colors,
A hue beyond description.
I know, I learned.
This is the endless end.

Breathe Away

Sunlight enters his home, wait,
Life after snow, with sparrows, start,
Iron wire leaps from cars to trees,
Dead woods became birds,
To fly,
suddenly free.

Feathers sway gently in the net,
With blue coffee spills on street,
still wet.
Pausing the golden stream, to
Freeze silent figures with papers' dream,
I savor such sweetness as morning gleam.

In the park, a black cat stands tall,
Breath the air,
away the hair,

Everything is fair.

Watching footsteps beyond the wall.
White goose rise with wings spread wild,
Leaving golden ripples, still in my mind,

Anywhere.